Where You Are: Safety and Support, the Middle of Step Two, and What Comes After It

The nine steps of the Family Care Roadmap, with yours marked.

Looking at who helps your mother is one part of a longer road, and not a large part. It's the middle topic of step two of nine, and nothing on the road has a date on it.

This page shows the whole road, where this part sits, and who is involved in what follows, by role.

Phase 1 · Care Assessment

Understand the person, the family, and the situation.

1 **Discover** Current Situation → Concerns & Challenges → Goals & Priorities
You finish with: Family Care Starting Profile

2 **Assess** Health & Function → Safety & Support → Lifestyle & Preferences
You finish with: Personal Care Baseline and Preferences Profile

You are here. You're on the middle topic of this step. The first looked at your mother's health and what she does for herself, this one looks at the help around her and the concerns worth raising, and the third is about how she prefers to live. Your part of this topic is done when a support map, your backup questions and a list for the professionals exist, and the family has agreed on a reason to look at them again.

3 **Define Needs** Needs & Risks → Care Requirements → Priorities & Recommendations
You finish with: Care Needs Profile and Future Action Roadmap

Phase 2 · Care Planning

Determine what good care should look like and prepare to put it in place.

4 **Explore Options** Care Setting → Provider/Facility Fit → Selection & Decision
You finish with: Preliminary Care Options Research and Decision Plan

5 **Build the Plan** Health & Personal Care → Daily Life & Quality of Life → Monitoring & Response
You finish with: Personal Care Planning File and Future Review Templates

6 **Prepare the Transition** Preparation → Move & Admission → Continuity of Care
You finish with: Transition-Readiness File and Future Handoff Template

Phase 3 · Care Management

Coordinate the plan, review what happens, and prepare the family to take the lead.

7 **Coordinate** People & Responsibilities → Communication & Handoffs → Care-Plan Alignment
You finish with: Care Team, Communication, and Meeting-Readiness Kit

8 **Monitor** Monitor → Identify & Escalate → Review & Adjust
You finish with: Monitoring, Advocacy, and Review-Readiness Kit

9 **Hand Off** Educate → Empower → Support

You finish with: Starter Family Care Playbook and Future Support Plan

What this part produces

Three short things on paper: a map of who helps your mother across an ordinary week, the questions about who could cover for each helper, and a list of the small concerns you'd like a professional to hear. With them goes a date, or a kind of change, that will bring the family back to the page. These are the family's notes, put in order. They aren't an assessment, and nothing on them says the arrangement should change.

None of it needs to be long. AARP's planning guide says a family's plan doesn't have to be extensive or fancy, and that it should stay open to modification as people's ability to help changes. [1]

What happens next

One more topic finishes step two: your mother's own preferences about how she lives. Together with the first topic, on her health and what she does for herself, the three make up what the roadmap calls the Personal Care Baseline and Preferences Profile.

If your family goes on with your care consultant, their part of this topic is a review: of anything you've noted about falls, supervision, how her medications are handled and the home, and of where the coverage has gaps. Recurring health concerns you've written down are recorded for her care team. Nobody writes care instructions from a family's notes.

After that comes step three, Define Needs. The rest of the road is there whenever your family wants it.

Who is involved, by role

For questions about falls and medicines, the CDC's brochure for family caregivers points families to her healthcare provider and her pharmacist. The rest of the roles are below. [2]

- Your mother: it's her week. She sees the map and can correct it, and her preferences are the next topic.
- You and your family: mapping, asking and writing down.
- The people who help, such as your sister and the neighbor: how it's going on their end, and what they are and aren't prepared to do.
- The people who might cover: only whether they'd be willing. Nobody is given a role here.
- Her doctor and her pharmacist: the clinical questions, including anything about falls or her medicines.
- With your care consultant: a review of the map and the concerns, alongside the family.

What this page doesn't promise

A timetable, anyone's availability, or a result. Families planning ahead take the steps at their own pace, and some pause for a long while between them.

Ready for the next step?

You know where this part sits and what follows it. The care interview is how the step gets done: it asks about your mother's health, the help around her and her preferences one area at a time, and builds a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

The nine steps are the Family Care Roadmap's own. The remark that a plan doesn't have to be extensive or fancy is AARP's, and the pointer to a healthcare provider and a pharmacist for questions about falls and medicines is the CDC's.

1. AARP, Prepare to Care: A Planning Guide for Families
2. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, Family Caregivers: Protect Your Loved Ones from Falling (STEADI brochure, 2018)
